

Express View on Trump's plan for Russia-Ukraine war: Europe's uncertain future

In the face of US President Donald Trump's diplomatic **blitzkrieg** on Ukraine, **Europe** — and Ukraine itself — **confront** the risk of **marginalisation**. After a 90-minute phone call with Russian President Vladimir Putin last week, Trump announced that **negotiations** to end the Russia-Ukraine war **would** begin "immediately". Officials from Washington and Moscow will reportedly hold talks in Saudi Arabia in the coming days to negotiate a **potential** peace agreement. **Kyiv**, however, **has** not been invited and does not plan to attend, while French President Emmanuel Macron is **convening** an emergency meeting of European leaders on the issue. Trump's **bold** moves **mark** a sharp **departure** from the approach of his **predecessor**, Joe Biden, who had not spoken to Putin since the Russian **invasion** and had **labelled** him a "murderous **dictator**". Trump's **outreach**, effectively, **ends** nearly three years of the West's **isolation** of Russia.

By all accounts, the Trump administration appears intent on getting along with the Kremlin and the resulting diplomatic **dissonance** between the US and Europe over Ukraine suggests that the West will remain a house divided in the near future. Russia currently occupies about a fifth of Ukraine and **insists** that Kyiv **cede** this land, which would eventually be **rendered** permanently "neutral". US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth appeared to **echo** this stance last week at the NATO headquarters in Brussels and dismissed a return to Ukraine's pre-2014 borders as "unrealistic" — a position undoubtedly welcomed by Moscow. Trump has even **gone on** to say that Ukraine "may be Russian" one day. **Alarmed** by the US president's **unilateral** moves, Europe is unlikely to **give in** easily — the emergency summit hosted by Paris is an indication. British Prime Minister Keir Starmer has reassured Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy that his country remains on an "irreversible path" to NATO membership, and that he will consider **deploying** British peacekeeping troops to support Kyiv. Trump's plan stands in sharp **contrast to** Europe's commitment to Ukraine's **sovereignty** and territorial **integrity**. If Trump's deal moves forward, Europe's best course of action may be to **bolster** its military alliance to effectively **deter** future Russian **expansionism**.

During his recent visit to the US, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said that "India is not neutral, India is siding with peace". Modi's diplomatic engagements last week **reflected** India's **commitment** to its ties with the US and France, the latter being the EU's second-most powerful country after Germany. At the same time, Delhi considers Moscow a reliable partner and would welcome any development that **arrests** the deepening of China and Russia's "no-limits" alliance. Peace in Europe would also bring economic stability, energy security, and increased trade opportunities for India on both sides of the divide. Western powers would have the time and the resources to shift their focus to **countering** China's growing influence in the Indo-Pacific — a key strategic priority for India. If it **ends up** giving peace a chance, a potential Trump-Putin agreement would bring gains for India too. **[Practice Exercise]**

Vocabulary

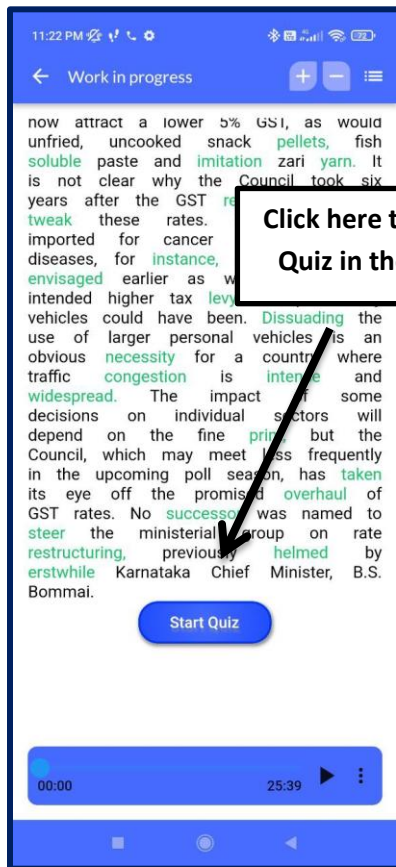
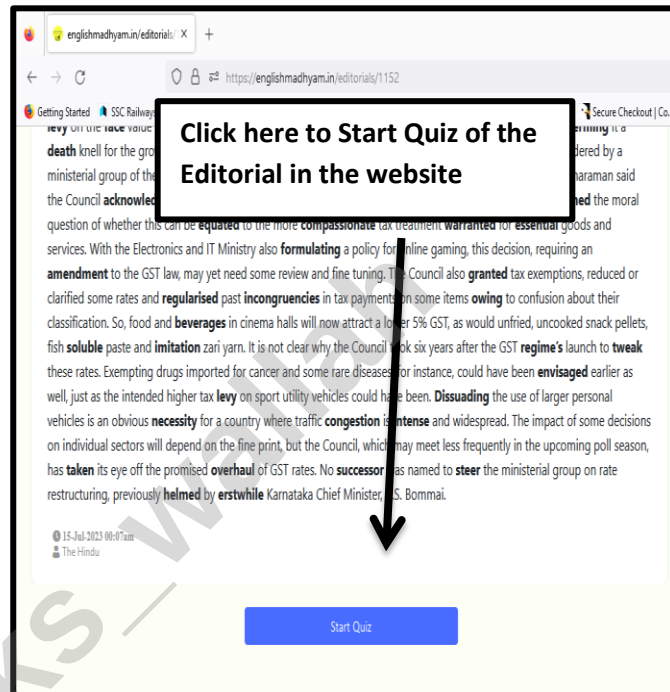
1. **In the face of** (phrase) – Despite, Against, Confronting, In opposition to, In the presence of के बावजूद
2. **Blitzkrieg** (noun) – Offensive, Assault, Attack, Onslaught, Raid तेज हमला
3. **Confront** (verb) – Face, Challenge, Encounter, Tackle, Address सामना करना
4. **Marginalisation** (noun) – Exclusion, Isolation, Alienation, Disregard, Neglect उपेक्षा
5. **Potential** (adjective) – Possible, Likely, Prospective, Probable, Feasible संभावित
6. **Convene** (verb) – Assemble, Gather, Summon, Call, Organize आयोजित करना
7. **Bold** (adjective) – Daring, Courageous, Audacious, Fearless, Confident साहसी
8. **Mark** (verb) – Indicate, Signify, Represent, Highlight, Symbolize चिह्नित करना
9. **Departure** (noun) – Deviation, Change, Shift, Break, Divergence परिवर्तन
10. **Predecessor** (noun) – Forerunner, Ancestor, Precedent, Former, Antecedent पूर्ववर्ती
11. **Invasion** (noun) – Attack, Incursion, Assault, Occupation, Raid आक्रमण
12. **Label** (verb) – Tag, Name, Identify, Classify, Brand लेबल लगाना
13. **Dictator** (noun) – Autocrat, Tyrant, Despot, Oppressor, Authoritarian तानाशाह
14. **Outreach** (noun) – Engagement, Communication, Interaction, Connection, Involvement संपर्क
15. **Isolation** (noun) – Separation, Segregation, Detachment, Loneliness, Exclusion अलगाव
16. **By all accounts** (phrase) – According to everyone, Universally, Reportedly, Allegedly, Evidently सभी के अनुसार
17. **Dissonance** (noun) – Conflict, Disagreement, Discord, Tension, Clash मतभेद
18. **Insist** (verb) – Demand, Assert, Maintain, Urge, Press जोर देना
19. **Cede** (verb) – Surrender, Yield, Relinquish, Give up, Abandon छोड़ना
20. **Render** (verb) – Make, Cause, Transform, Convert, Provide बनाना
21. **Echo** (verb) – Repeat, Mimic, Reflect, Resonate, Imitate दोहराना
22. **Go on** (phrasal verb) – Continue, Proceed, Persist, Carry on, Advance जारी रखना

23. **Alarm** (verb) – Frighten, Startle, Shock, Disturb, Panic चिंतित करना
24. **Unilateral** (adjective) – One-sided, Independent, Solo, Exclusive, Autonomous एकतरफा
25. **Give in** (phrasal verb) – Surrender, Yield, Submit, Concede, Relent झुक जाना
26. **Deploy** (verb) – Utilize, Employ, Position, Dispatch, Mobilize तैनात करना
27. **In contrast to** (phrase) – Unlike, Compared to, As opposed to, Differently from, Contrary to के विपरीत
28. **Sovereignty** (noun) – Independence, Autonomy, Authority, Supremacy, Dominion संप्रभुता
29. **Integrity** (noun) – Honesty, Unity, Wholeness, Morality, Rectitude अखंडता
30. **Bolster** (verb) – Strengthen, Support, Reinforce, Boost, Fortify मजबूत करना
31. **Deter** (verb) – Prevent, Discourage, Hinder, Inhibit, Block रोकना
32. **Expansionism** (noun) – Imperialism, Aggression, Domination, Growth, Extension विस्तारवाद
33. **Reflect** (verb) – Indicate, Show, Demonstrate, Reveal, Display प्रतिबिंबित करना
34. **Commitment** (noun) – Dedication, Pledge, Promise, Obligation, Assurance प्रतिबद्धता
35. **Arrest** (verb) – Stop, Halt, Check, Prevent, Block रोकना
36. **Counter** (verb) – Oppose, Resist, Combat, Challenge, Defy विरोध करना
37. **End up** (phrasal verb) – Conclude, Finish, Result, Wind up, Land परिणाम होना

Summary of the Editorial

1. **Trump's Diplomatic Shift:** Former US President Donald Trump's proactive diplomatic push aims to resolve the Russia-Ukraine war, marking a sharp shift from Biden's approach.
2. **Unilateral Negotiations:** Trump announced immediate negotiations with Russia after a 90-minute phone call with Putin, sidelining Ukraine from the process.
3. **Talks in Saudi Arabia:** US and Russian officials are set to meet in Saudi Arabia for potential peace talks, but Ukraine has not been invited and does not plan to attend.
4. **European Response:** French President Emmanuel Macron has called an emergency meeting of European leaders to address the situation.
5. **Break from Biden's Policy:** Unlike Biden, who isolated Russia and called Putin a "murderous dictator," Trump is engaging directly with Moscow, effectively ending three years of Western diplomatic isolation of Russia.
6. **US-Europe Divide:** Trump's Russia-friendly stance has created a diplomatic rift between the US and Europe, making the West appear divided on Ukraine's future.
7. **Russian Territorial Demands:** Russia occupies about 20% of Ukraine and demands Kyiv permanently cede this land, turning Ukraine into a neutral zone.
8. **US Position on Ukraine's Borders:** US Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth has called the idea of restoring Ukraine's pre-2014 borders "unrealistic," aligning with Russia's interests.
9. **Trump's Provocative Statement:** Trump has controversially suggested that Ukraine might become part of Russia in the future, further unsettling European allies.
10. **European Resistance:** European leaders, including British PM Keir Starmer, have reaffirmed their commitment to Ukraine's sovereignty, NATO membership, and possible deployment of peacekeeping forces.
11. **Strengthening European Defense:** If Trump's deal advances, Europe may need to reinforce its military alliance to counter potential Russian aggression.
12. **India's Neutral Diplomacy:** Indian PM Narendra Modi emphasized that India sides with peace while maintaining close ties with the US, France, and Russia.
13. **India's Strategic Interests:** A peaceful Europe would enhance economic stability, energy security, and trade opportunities for India.
14. **Balancing China's Influence:** A resolution in Ukraine would allow Western powers to shift focus toward countering China in the Indo-Pacific, aligning with India's strategic priorities.
15. **Potential Global Gains:** If Trump's peace initiative succeeds, it could benefit India by reducing Russia's dependence on China while stabilizing Europe and the global economy.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based

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